Center Forwards

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Player counts

In this project, there are a total of 76 center forwards considered, with

- 14 center forwards in 12 teams in the English FA Women's Super League
- 17 center forwards in 12 teams in the German Frauen Bundesliga
- 29 center forwards in 16 teams in the Spanish Liga F
- 16 center forwards in 10 teams in the Italian Serie A Women

Results

Results for 2 clusters

Breakdown of results by league

league	FA Women's Super League	Frauen Bundesliga	Liga F	Serie A Women
kmeans_2_cluster				
0	8	11	17	11
1	6	6	12	5

The split is more lopsided towards cluster 0, except for England's Women's Super League where the split was almost equal.

Breakdown of results by features

- Cluster 0 shows more positiveness towards forward passes, header passes and shots, backward carries, variance in location of involvement down the pitch, and quality of chances. Passing was the main method of progression.
- On the other hand, positiveness in cluster 1 can be seen in average carrying distance, forward carries, average location of involvement down the pitch (receiving, dribbling, turnovers), longer shot distances, and counterpress actions in opposing half. Carrying was the main method of progression.

Therefore, based on these results,

- Cluster 0 forwards can be seen as deep lying forwards.
- Cluster 1 forwards can be seen as advanced pressing forwards.

Results for 3 clusters

Breakdown of results by league

league	FA Women's Super League	Frauen Bundesliga	Liga F	Serie A Women
kmeans_3_cluster				
0	6	5	9	5
1	5	6	12	5

league	FA Women's Super League	Frauen Bundesliga	Liga F	Serie A Women
kmeans_3_cluster				
2	3	6	8	6

The split was quite equal between all three clusters.

Comparing results for 2 clusters against 3 clusters

kmeans_3_cluster	0	1	2
kmeans_2_cluster			
0	0	25	22
1	25	3	1

While most of k = 2 cluster 1 is converted into k = 3 cluster 0, k = 2 cluster 0 is divided further into k = 3 cluster 1 and 2. Interestingly, no players belong to k = 2 cluster 0 and k = 3 cluster 0.

Breakdown of results by features

- Cluster 0 forwards carried longer and more forward, involved at more advanced locations both in terms of receiving, dribbling, defending, and turning the ball over. Main method of progression is carrying.
- While for cluster 1 forwards, they passed more backward on the ground, had the highest quality of shots, involved at more varied locations.
- Cluster 2 forwards, on the other hand, passed more forward and progressive, while also stood out for switch passes, header passes and shots, passing lengths, backward carries. Main method of progression is passing.

Hence, the following conclusions can be made:

- Similar to k = 2 cluster 1, k = 3 cluster 0 forwards can be seen as advanced pressing forwards.
- Cluster 1 forwards can be interpreted as poachers whose goal was focused only on finishing chances.
- While cluster 2 forwards can be seen as target forwards.

Breakdown of results by players

Findings and radar plots for each center forward are in their own files:

- Mayra Ramirez - Levante
- Mayra Ramirez - Chelsea
- Gabi Nunes - Levante
- Rachel Daly - Aston Villa
- Khadija Shaw - Manchester City
- Alba Redondo - Levante
- Andrea Staskova - AC Milan

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Appendix

Radar plots for 2 clusters center forwards' averages

All leagues

Passing

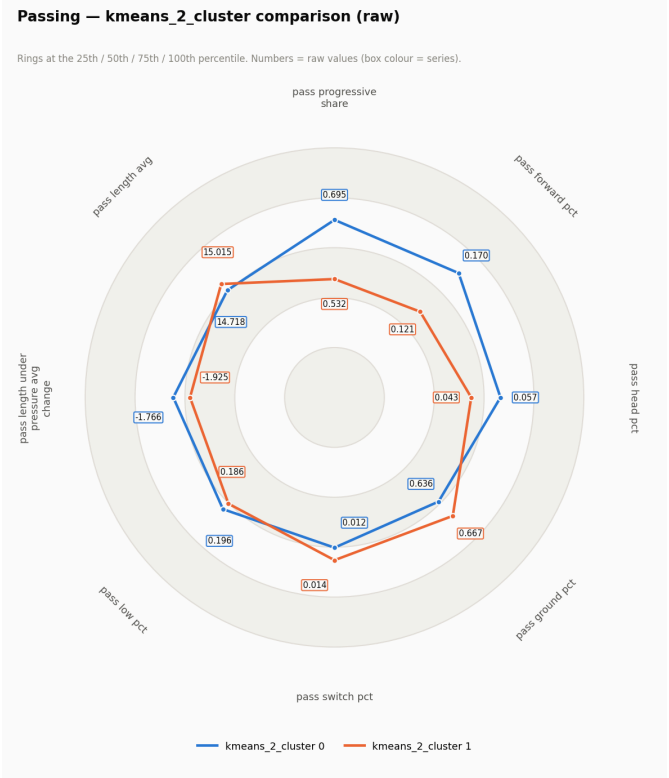


Figure 1: Center Forwards Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

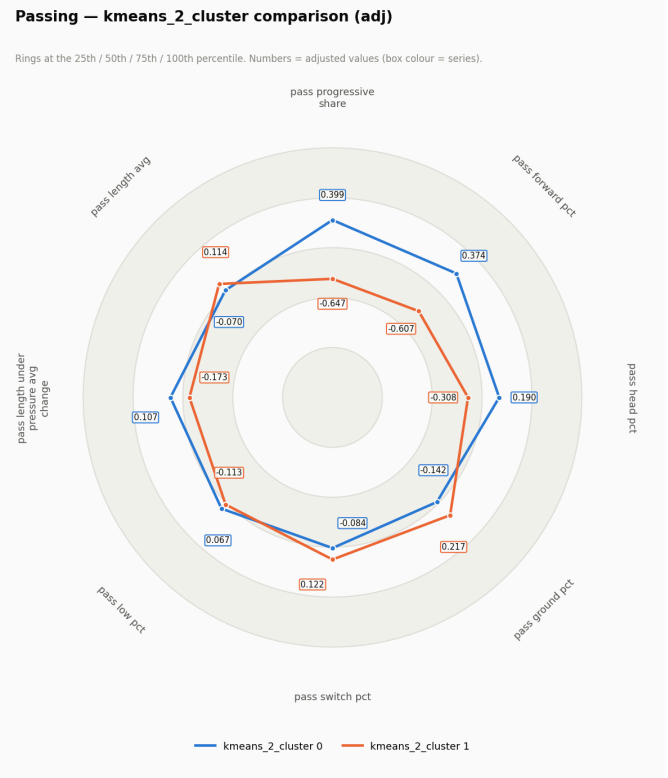


Figure 2: Center Forwards Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt

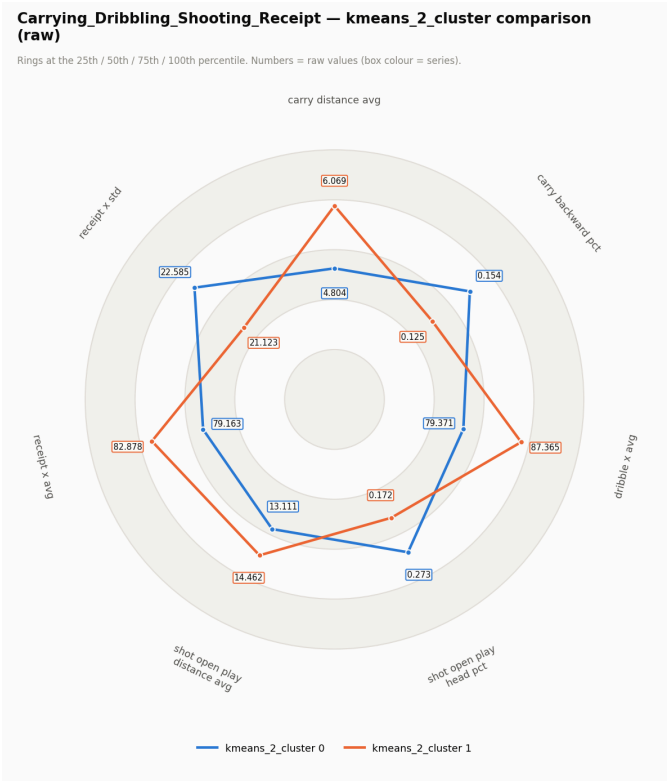


Figure 3: Center Forwards Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

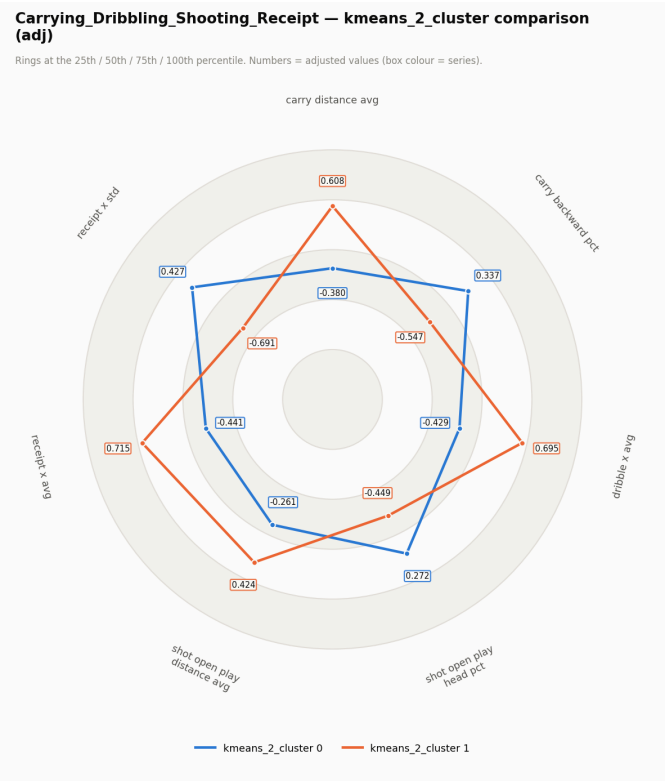


Figure 4: Center Forwards Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

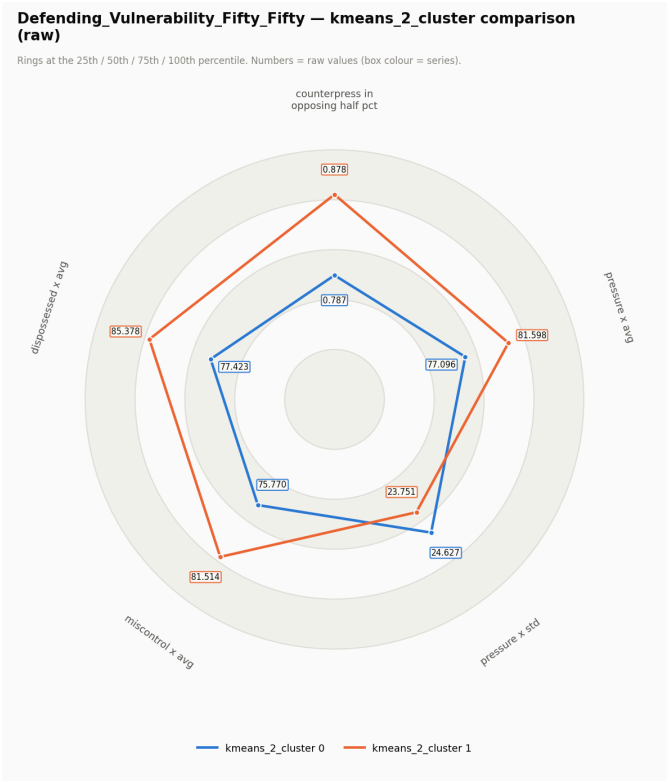


Figure 5: Center Forwards Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

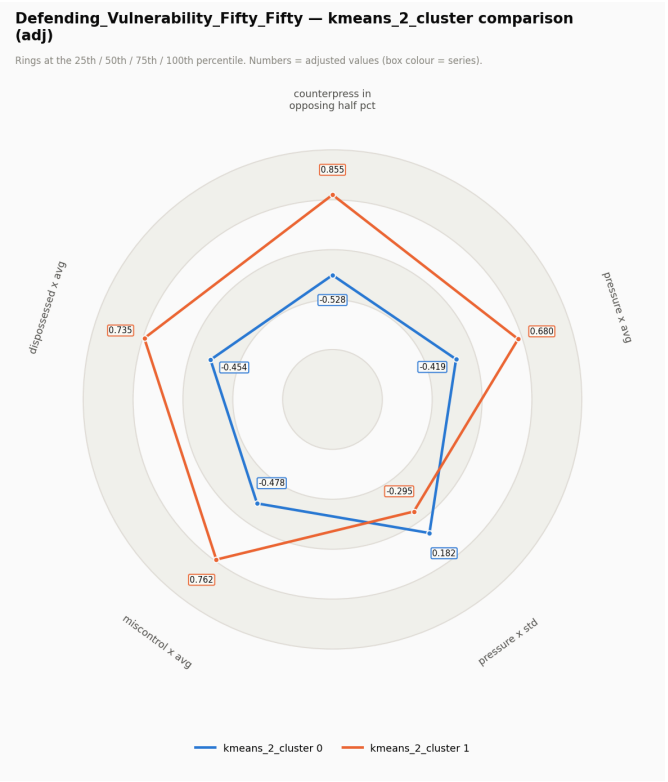


Figure 6: Center Forwards Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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FA Women's Super League

Passing

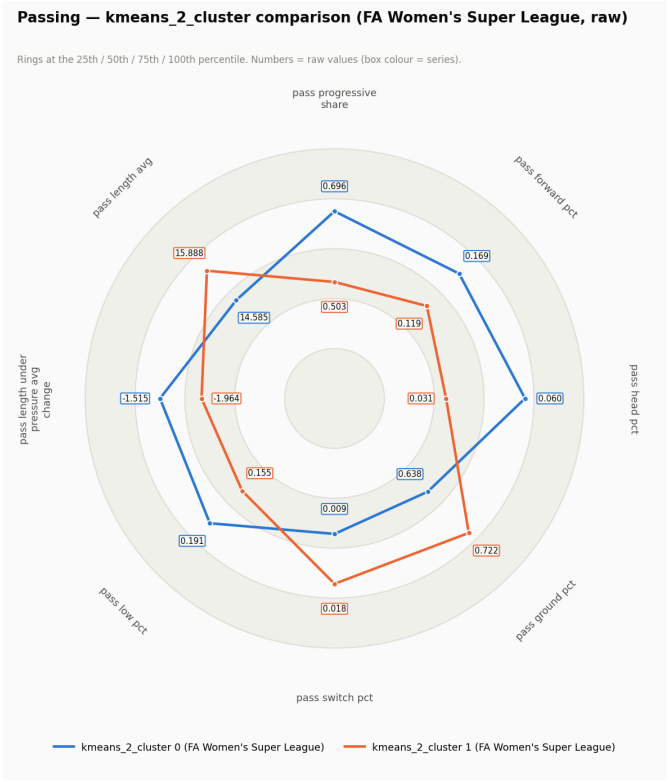


Figure 7: England Center Forwards Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

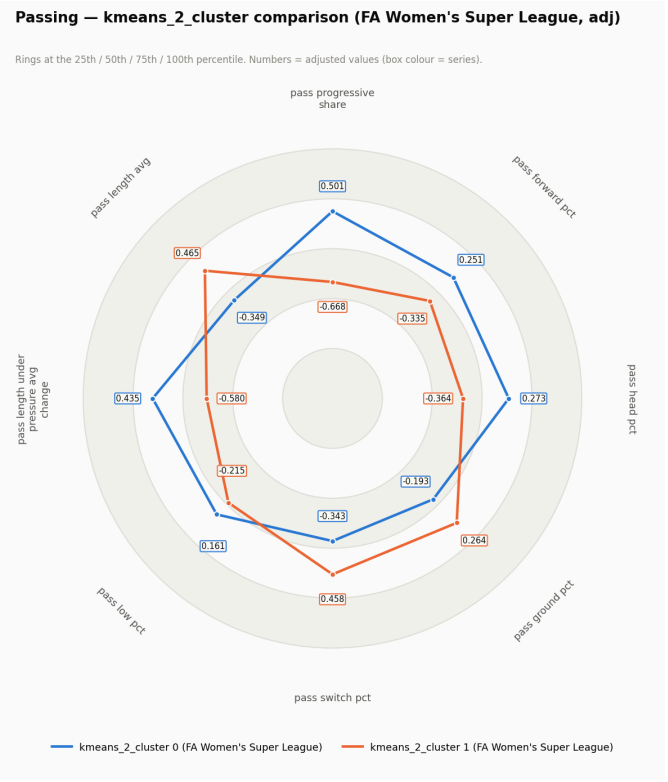


Figure 8: England Center Forwards Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt

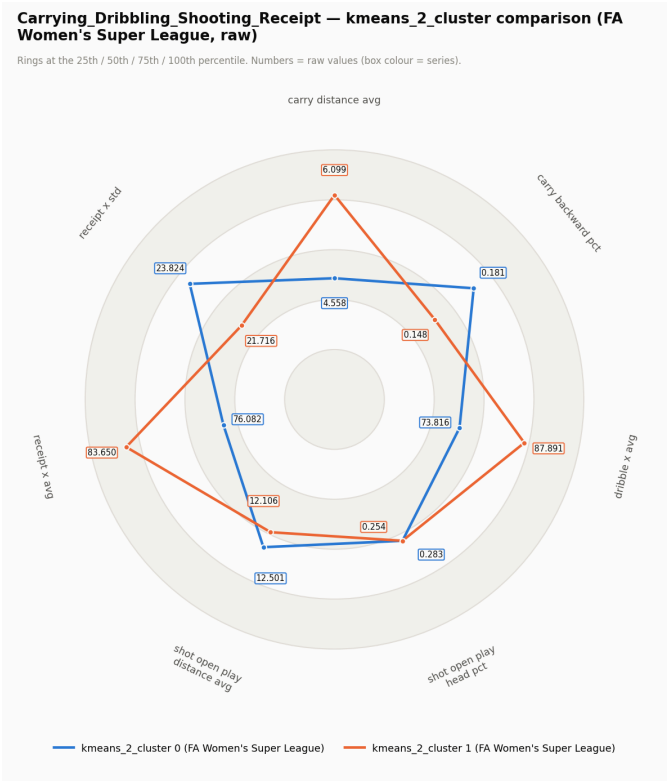


Figure 9: England Center Forwards Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

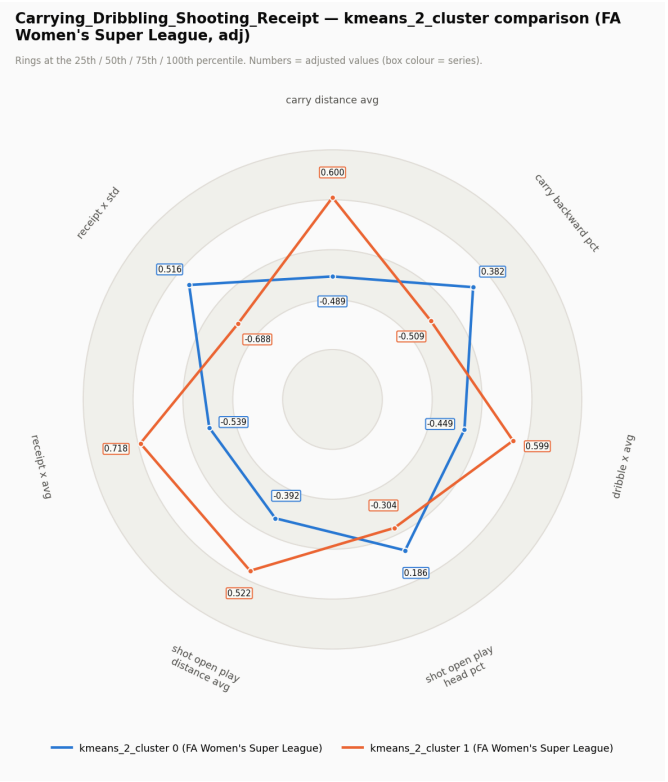


Figure 10: England Center Forwards Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

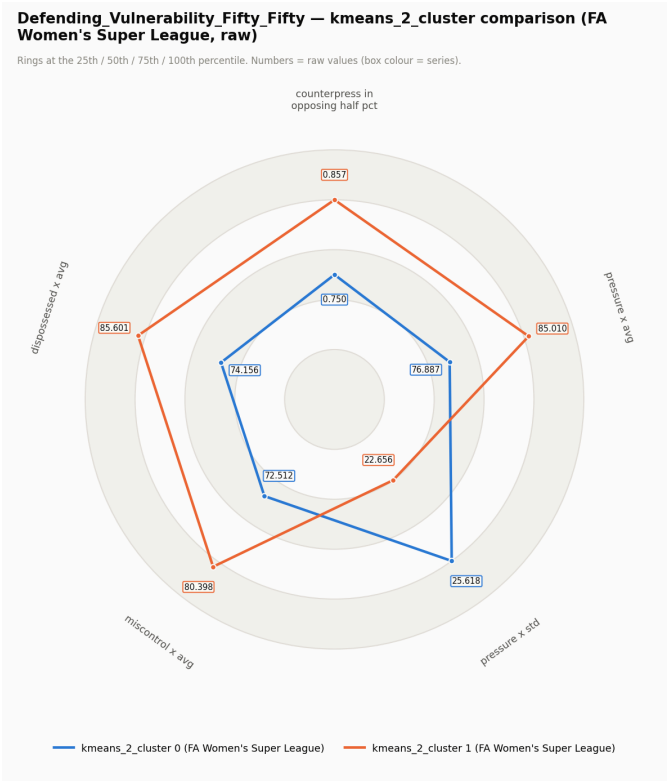


Figure 11: England Center Forwards Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

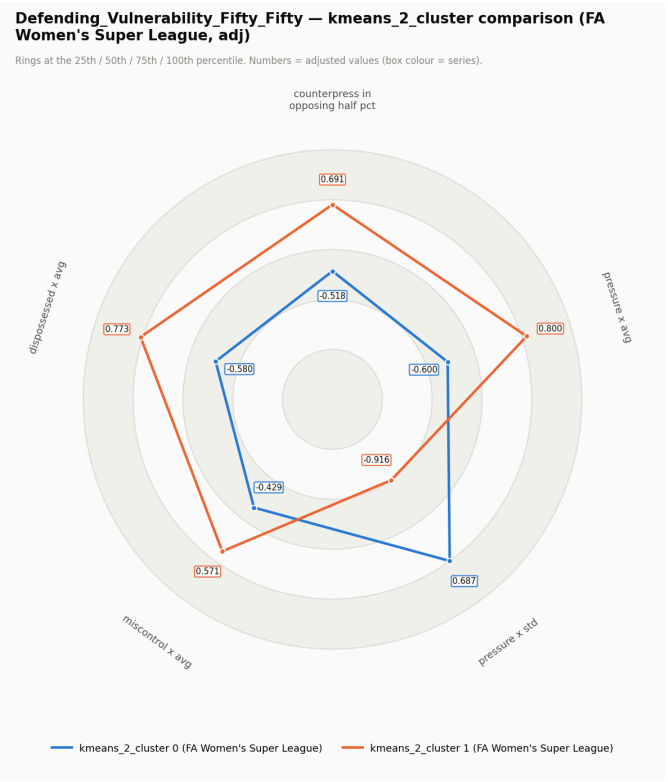


Figure 12: England Center Forwards Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Frauen Bundesliga

Passing

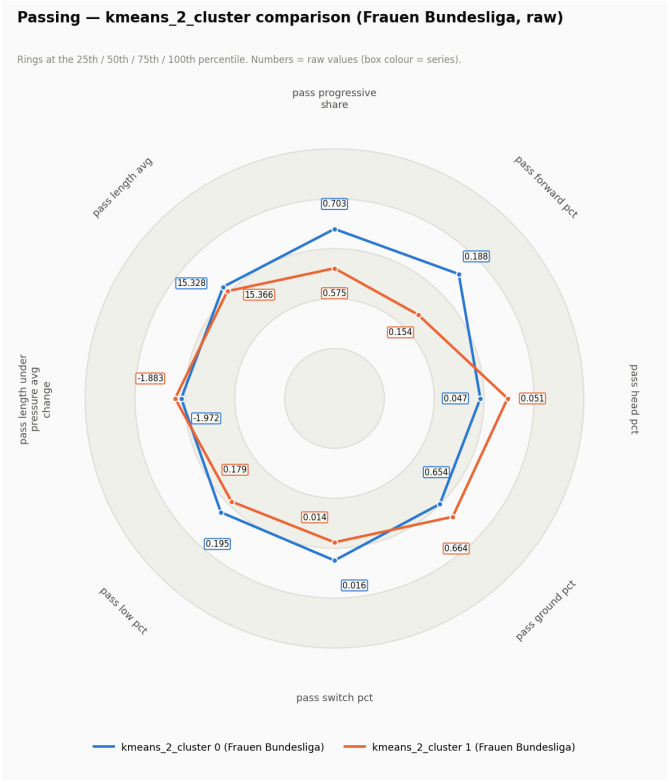


Figure 13: Germany Center Forwards Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

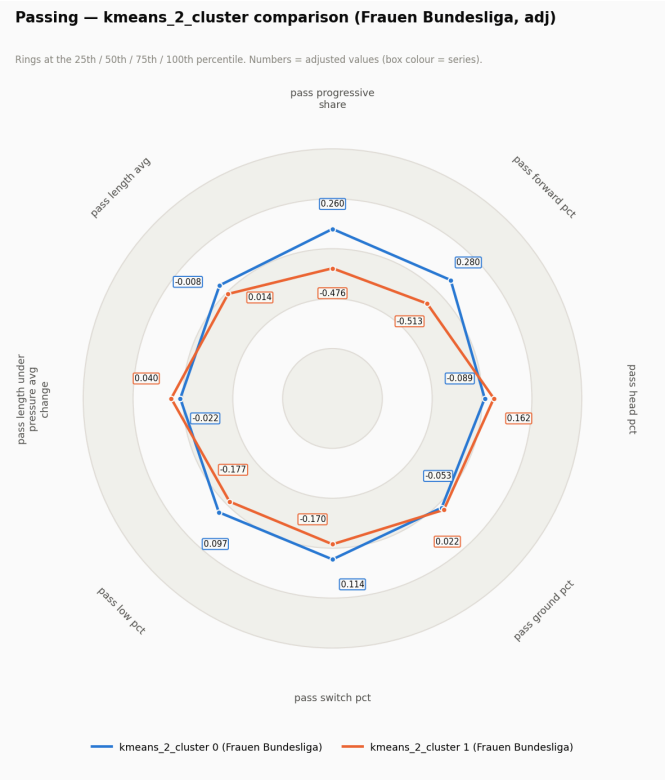


Figure 14: Germany Center Forwards Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt

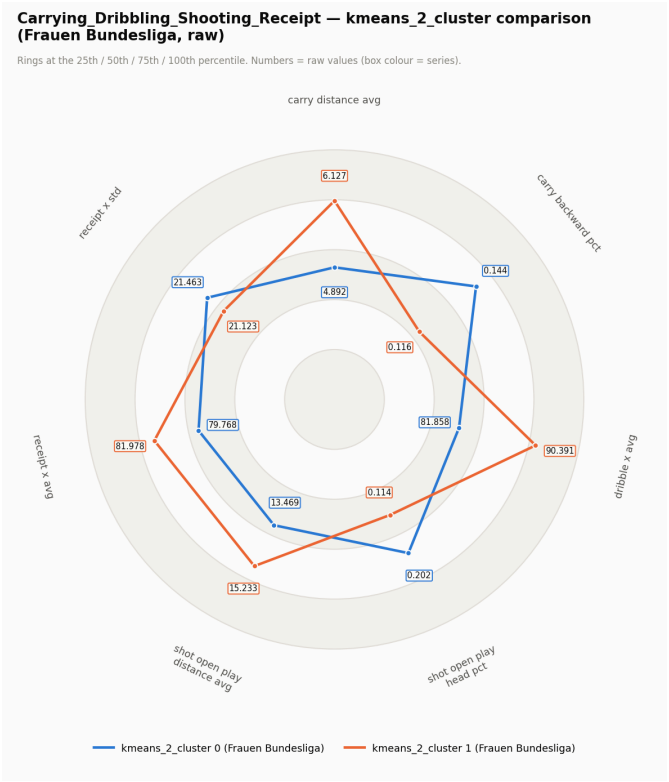


Figure 15: Germany Center Forwards Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

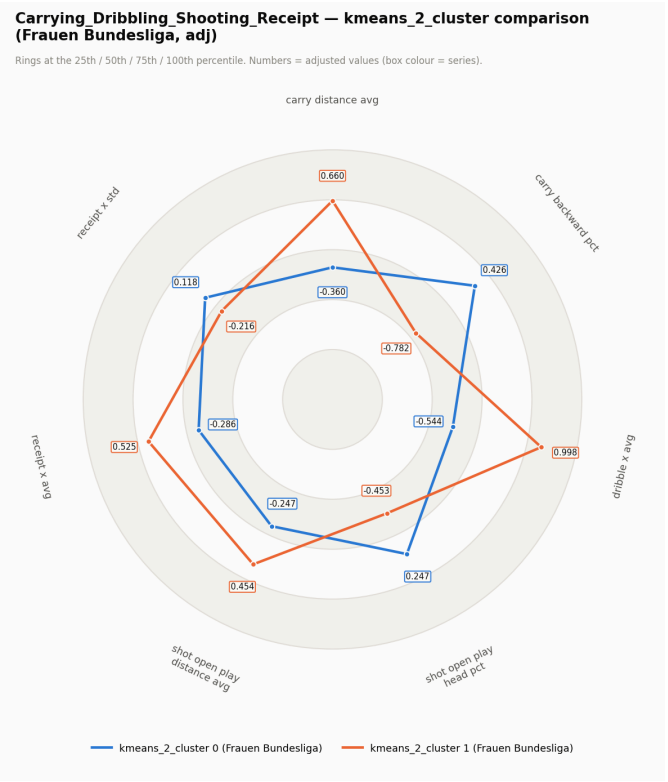


Figure 16: Germany Center Forwards Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

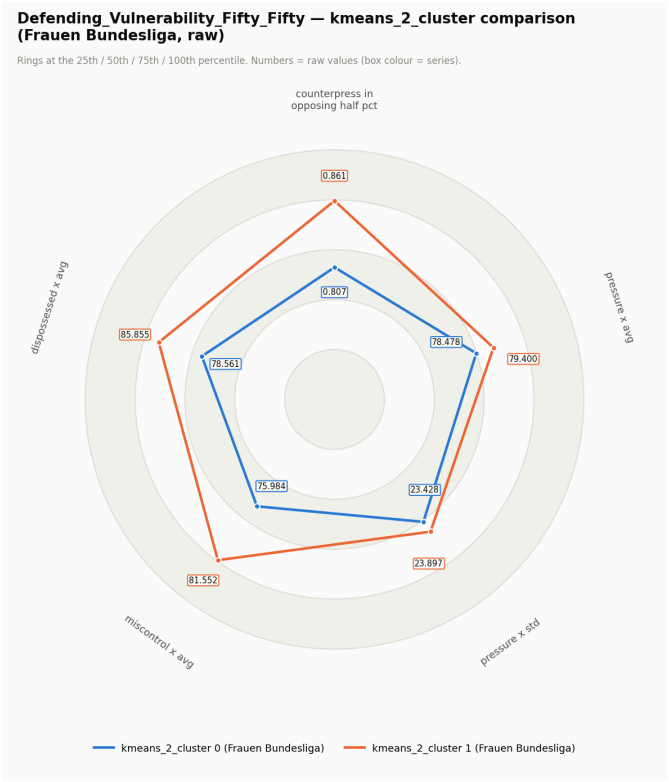


Figure 17: Germany Center Forwards Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

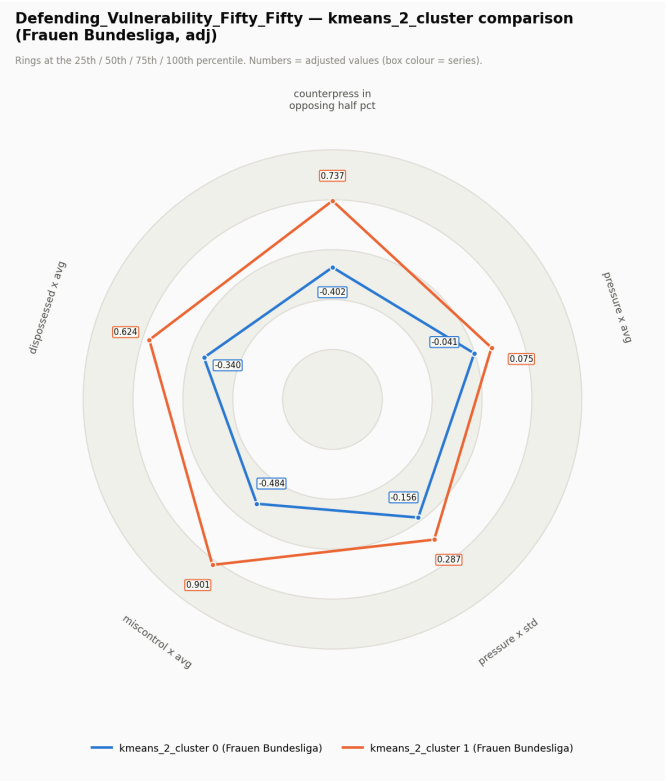


Figure 18: Germany Center Forwards Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Liga F

Passing

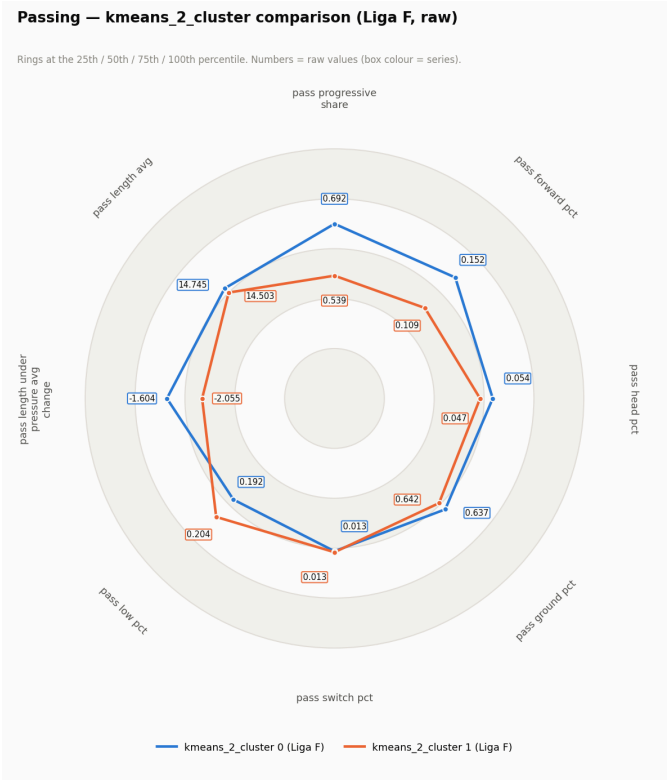


Figure 19: Spain Center Forwards Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

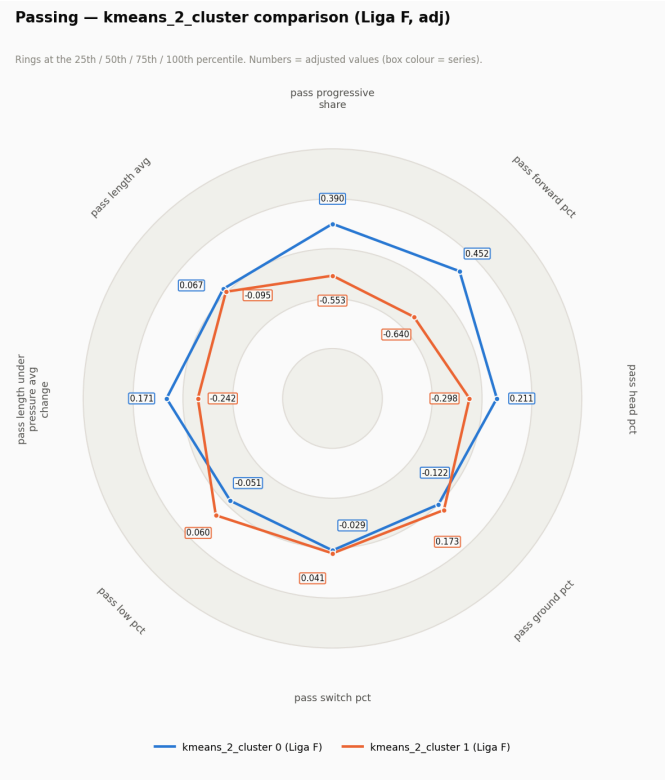


Figure 20: Spain Center Forwards Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt

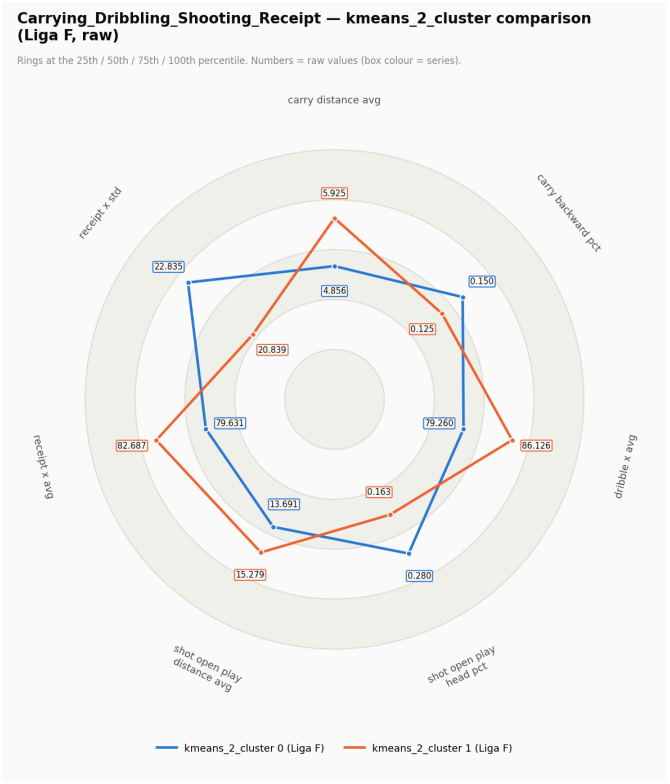


Figure 21: Spain Center Forwards Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

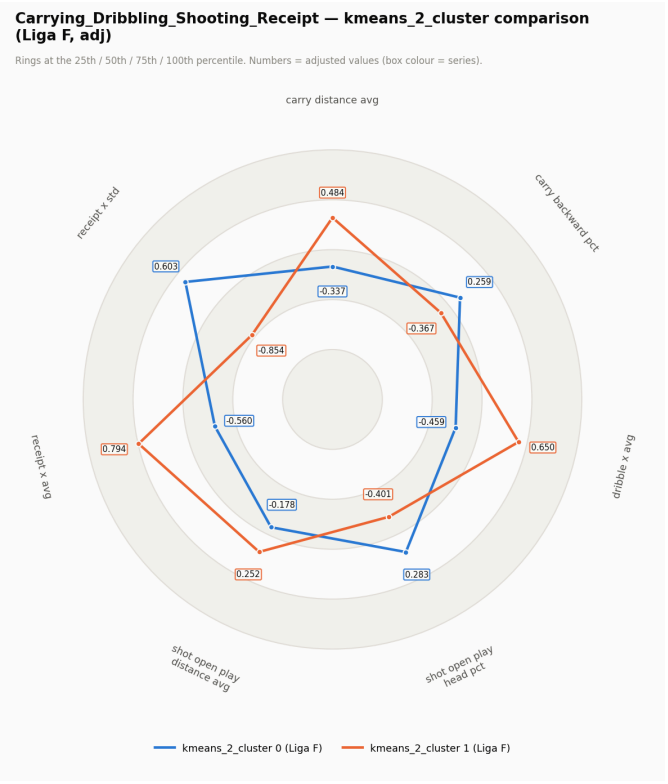


Figure 22: Spain Center Forwards Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

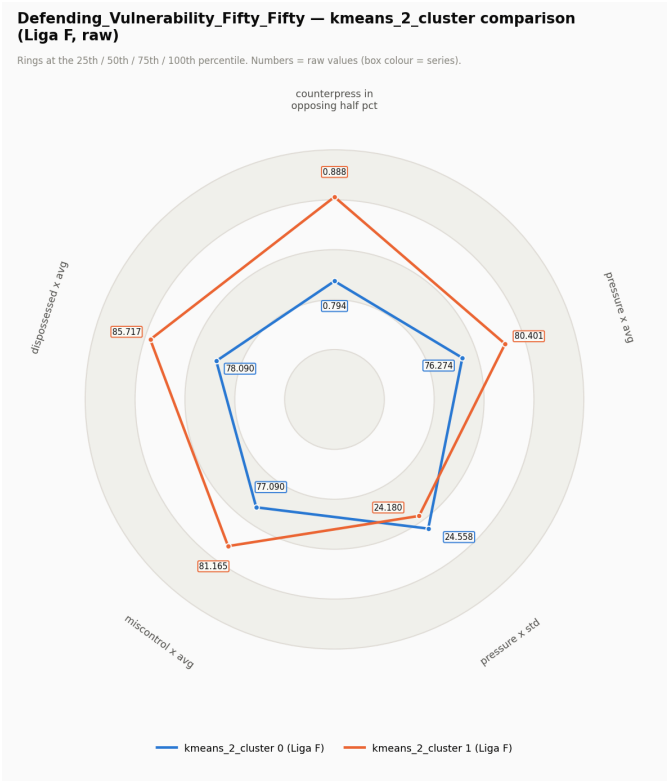


Figure 23: Spain Center Forwards Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

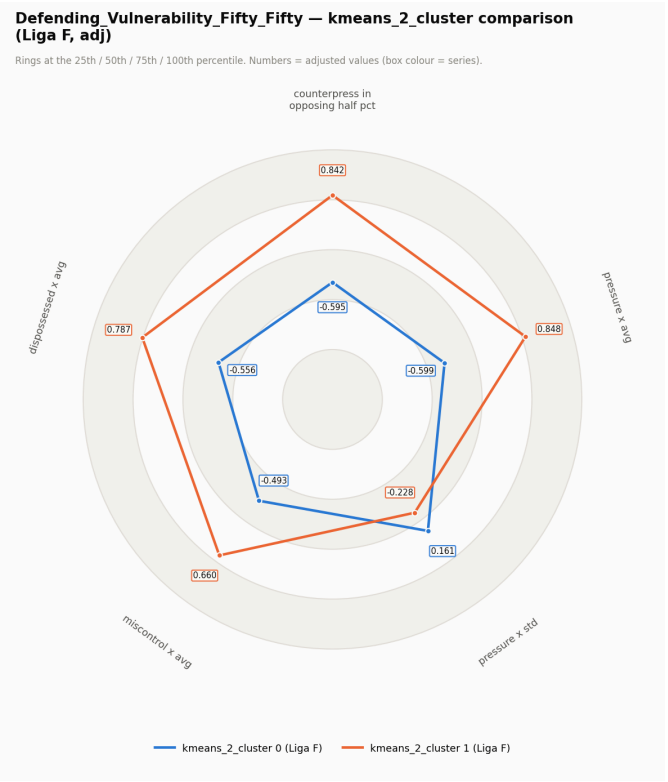


Figure 24: Spain Center Forwards Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Serie A Women

Passing

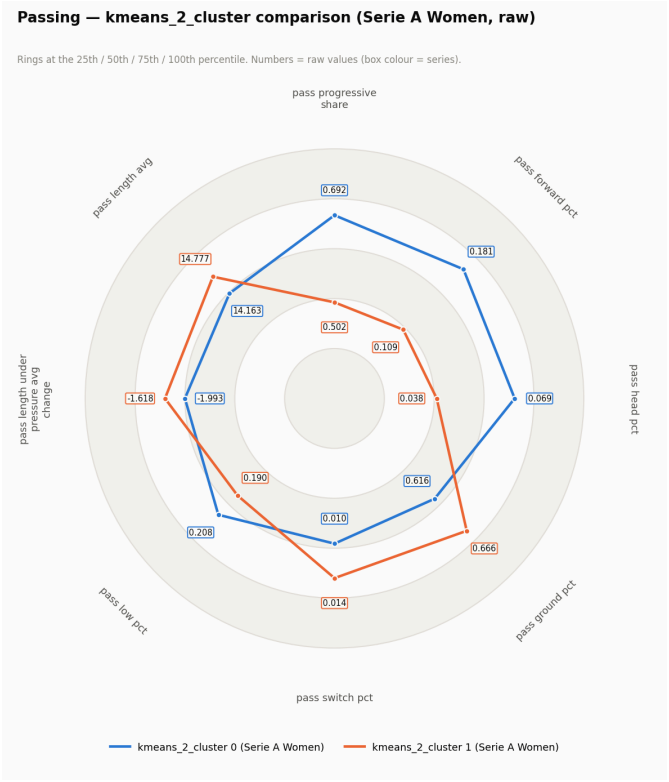


Figure 25: Italy Center Forwards Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

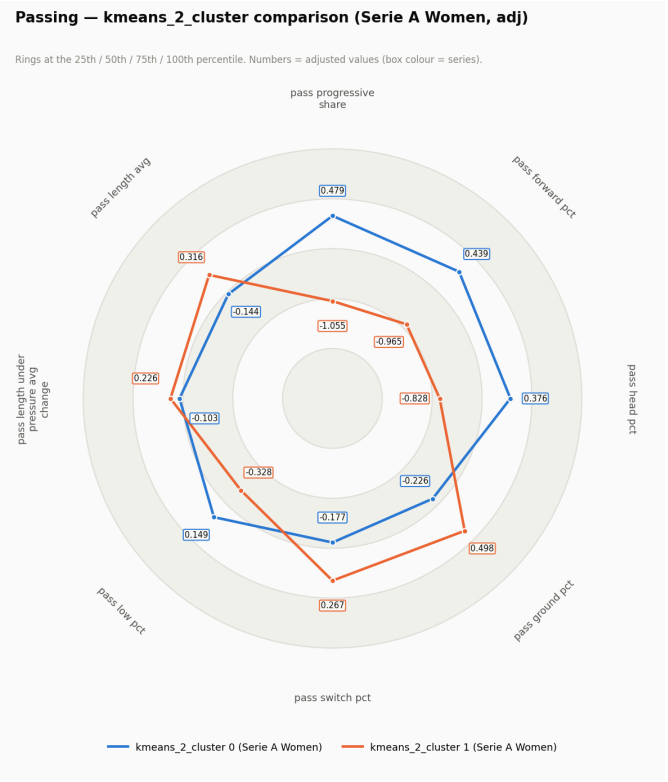


Figure 26: Italy Center Forwards Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt

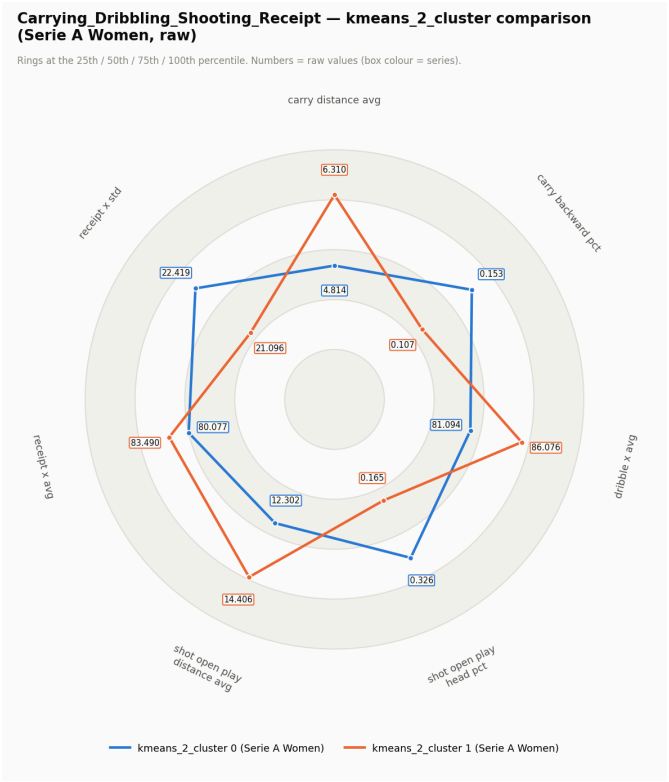


Figure 27: Italy Center Forwards Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

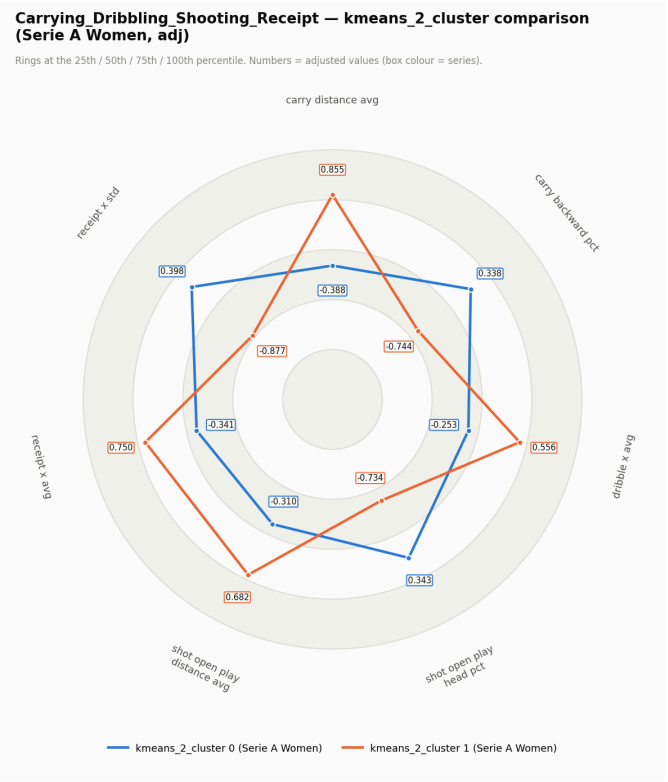


Figure 28: Italy Center Forwards Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

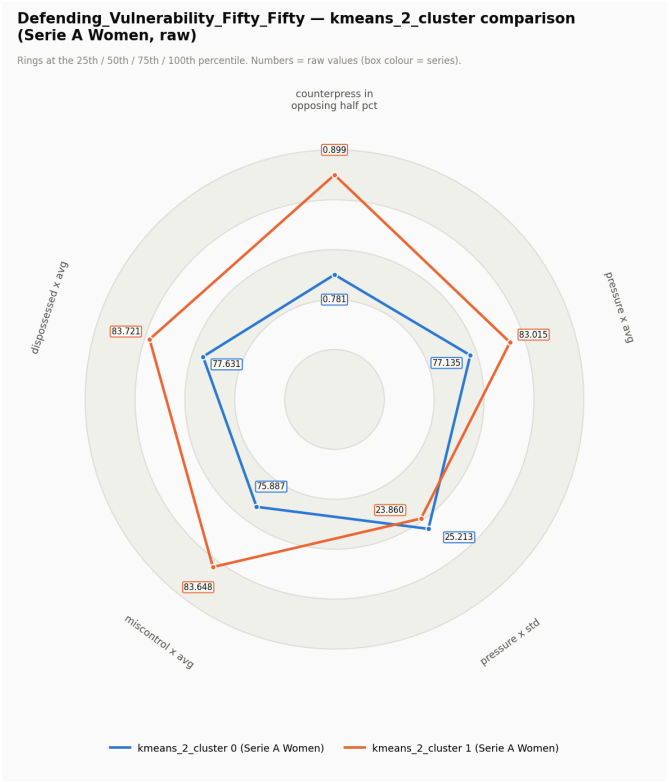


Figure 29: Italy Center Forwards Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

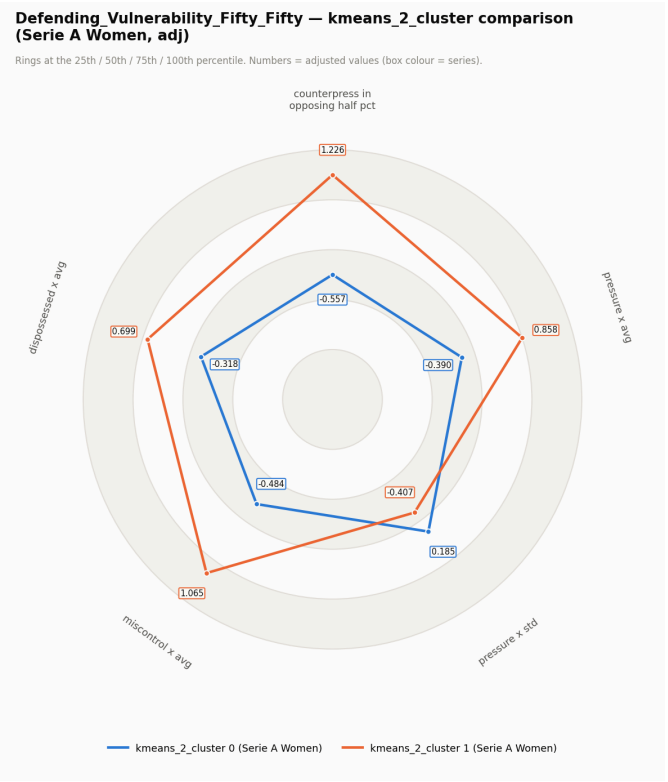


Figure 30: Italy Center Forwards Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Radar plots for 3 clusters center forwards' averages

All leagues

Passing

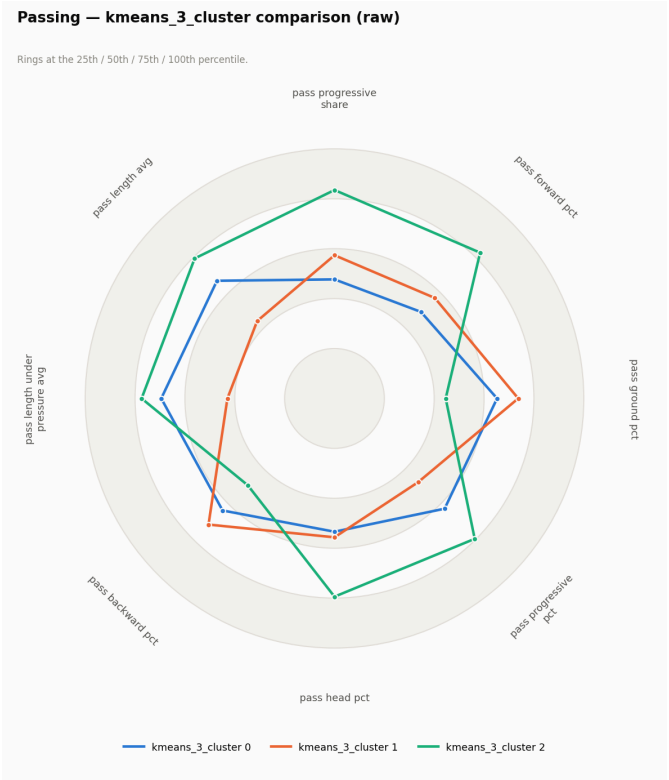


Figure 31: Center Forwards Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

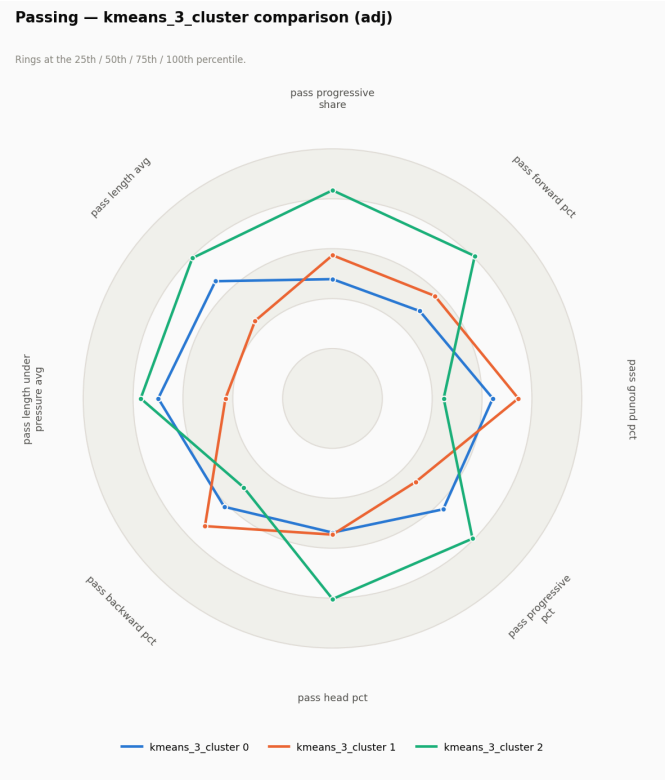


Figure 32: Center Forwards Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt

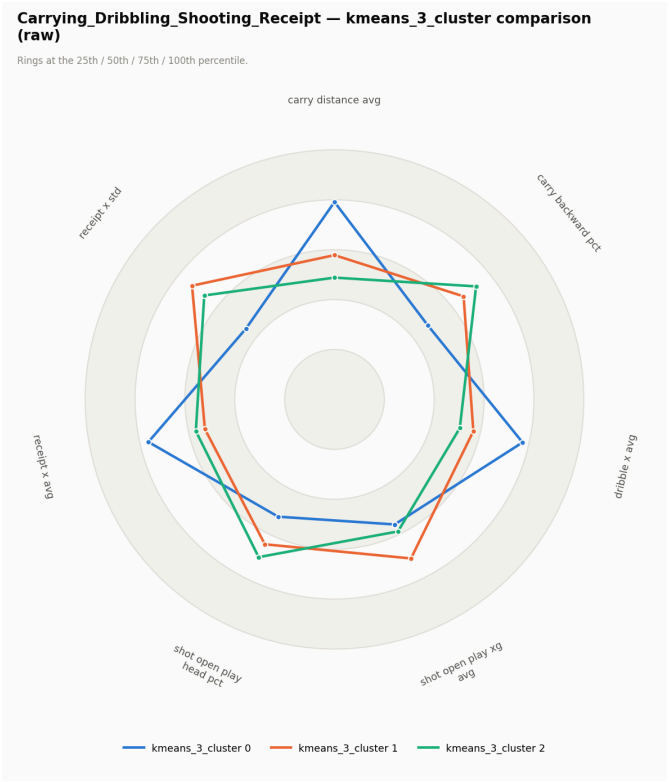


Figure 33: Center Forwards Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

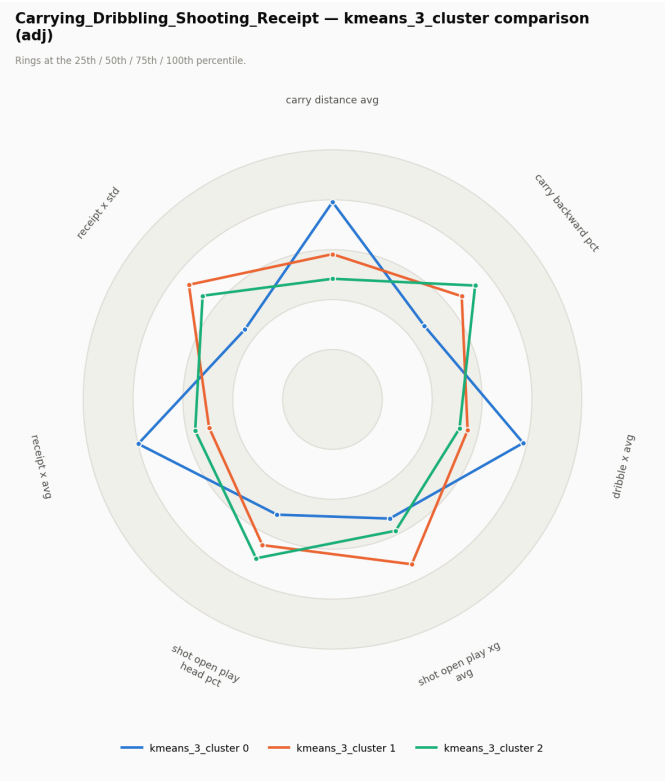


Figure 34: Center Forwards Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

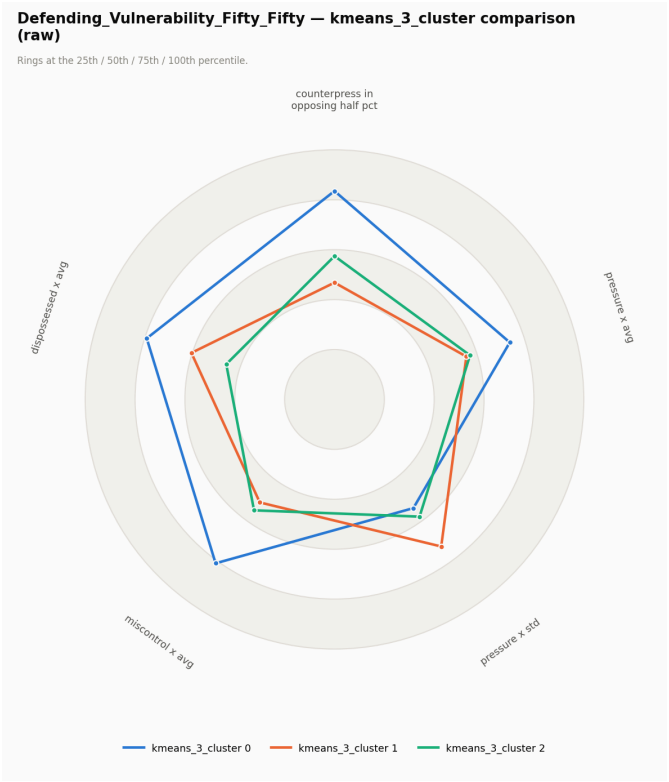


Figure 35: Center Forwards Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

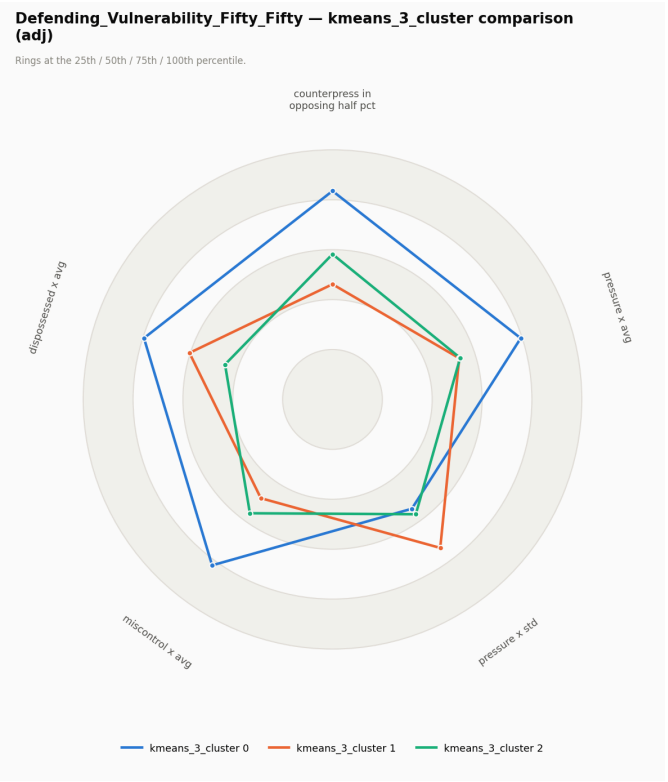


Figure 36: Center Forwards Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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FA Women's Super League

Passing

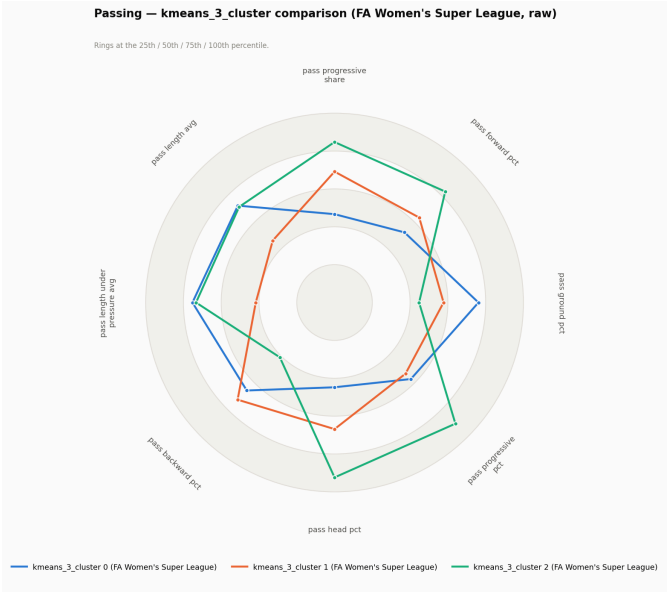


Figure 37: England Center Forwards Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

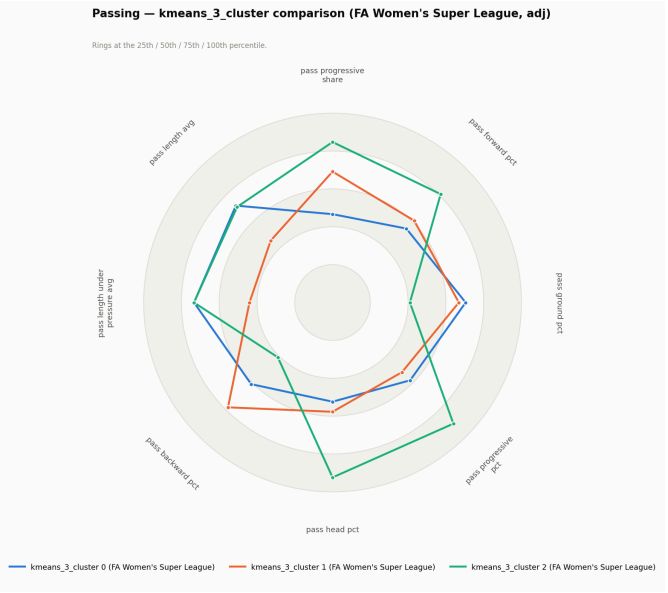


Figure 38: England Center Forwards Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt

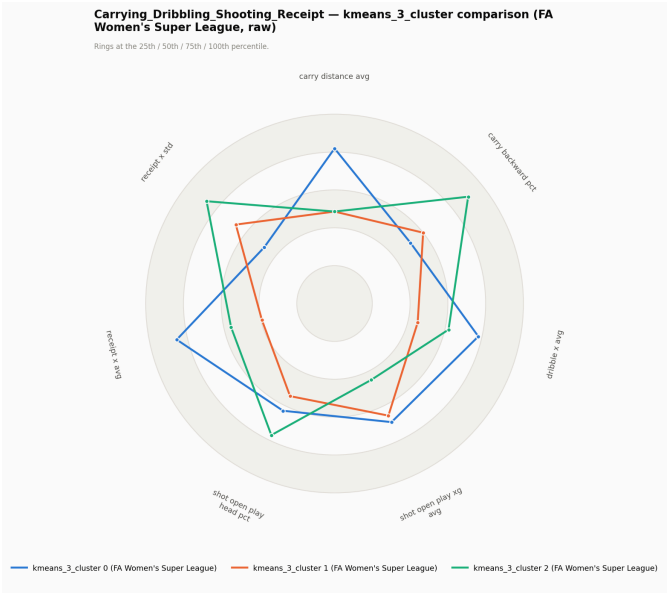


Figure 39: England Center Forwards Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

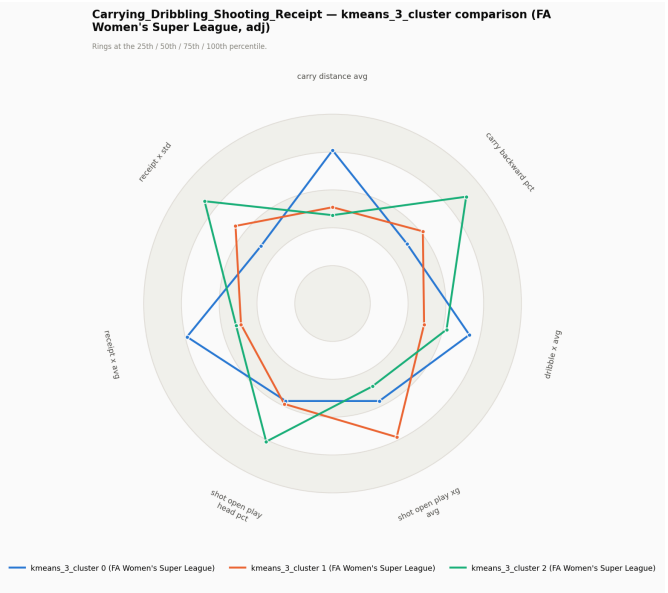


Figure 40: England Center Forwards Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

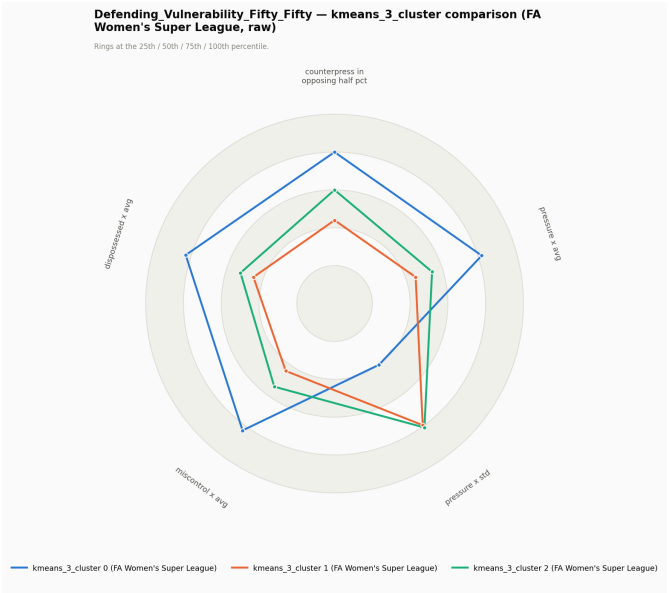


Figure 41: England Center Forwards Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

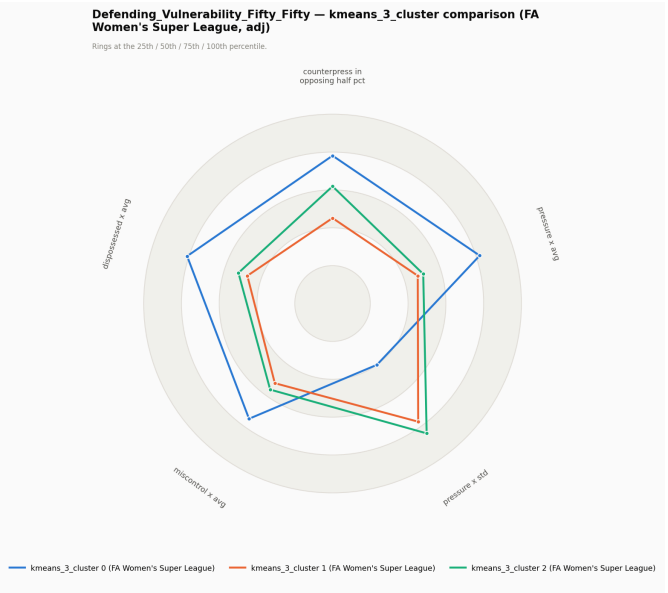


Figure 42: England Center Forwards Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Frauen Bundesliga

Passing

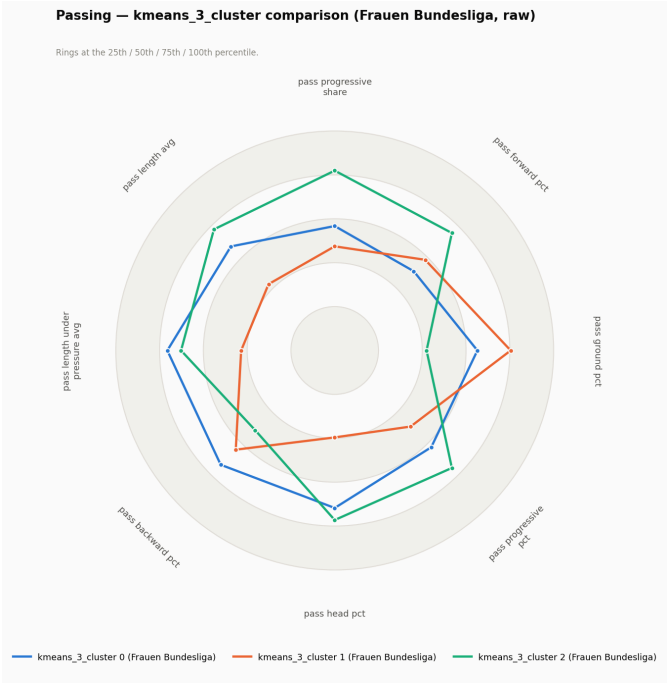


Figure 43: Germany Center Forwards Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

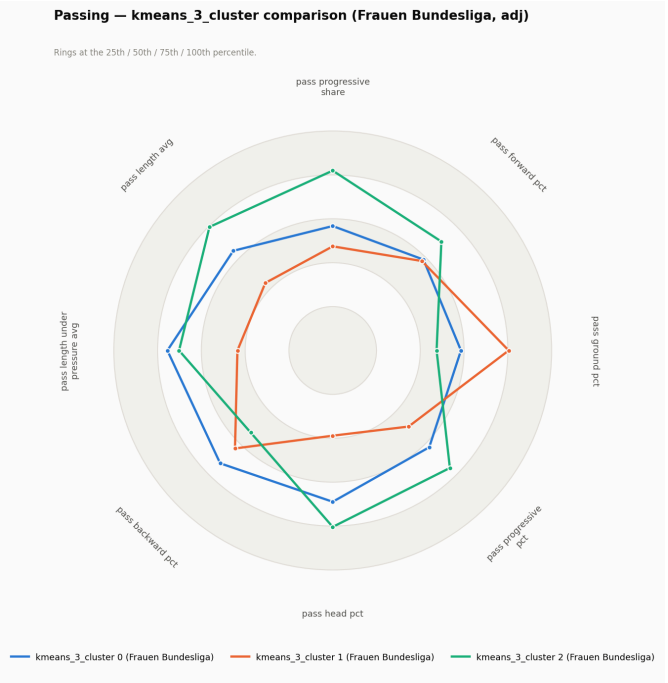


Figure 44: Germany Center Forwards Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt

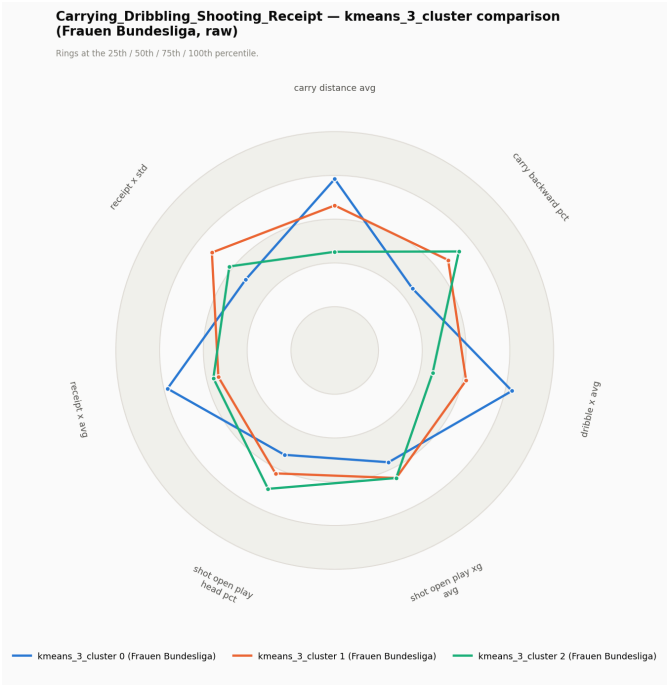


Figure 45: Germany Center Forwards Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

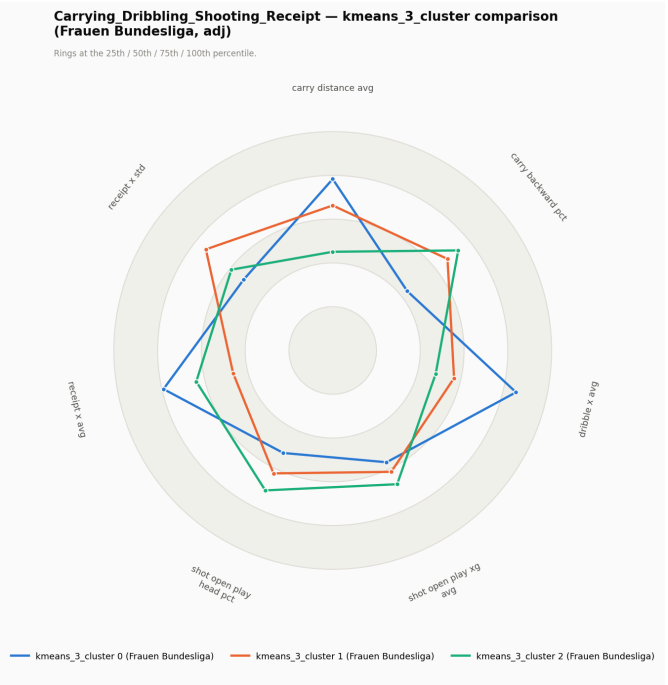


Figure 46: Germany Center Forwards Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

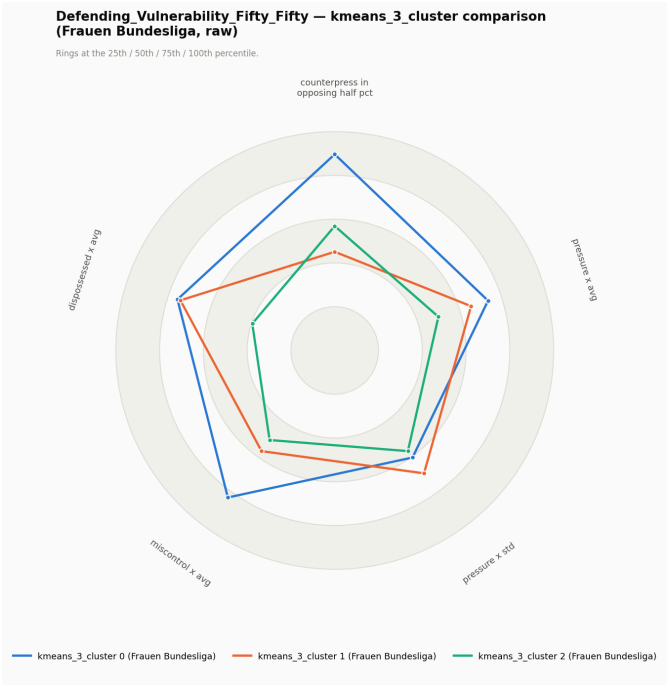


Figure 47: Germany Center Forwards Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

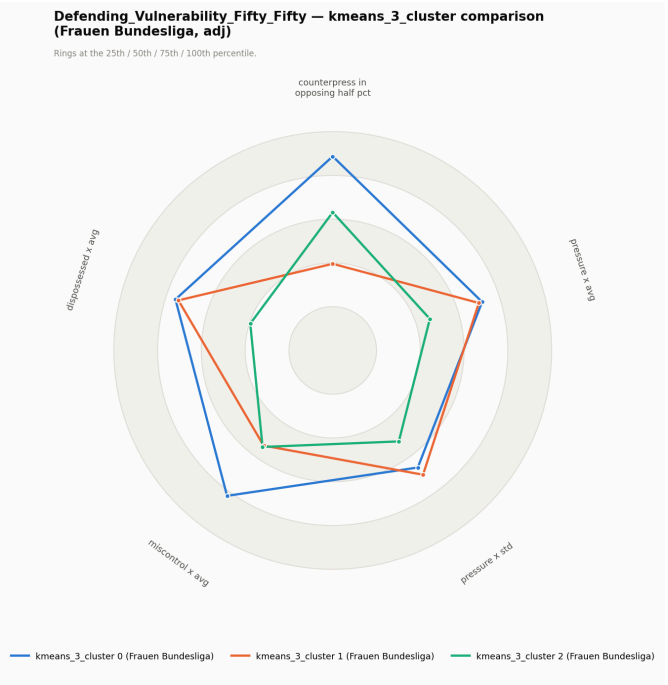


Figure 48: Germany Center Forwards Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Liga F

Passing

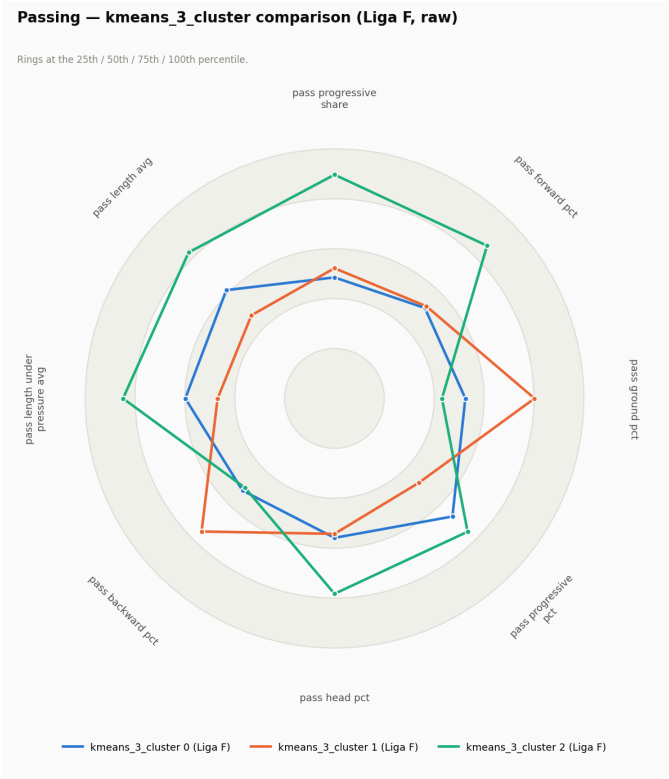


Figure 49: Spain Center Forwards Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

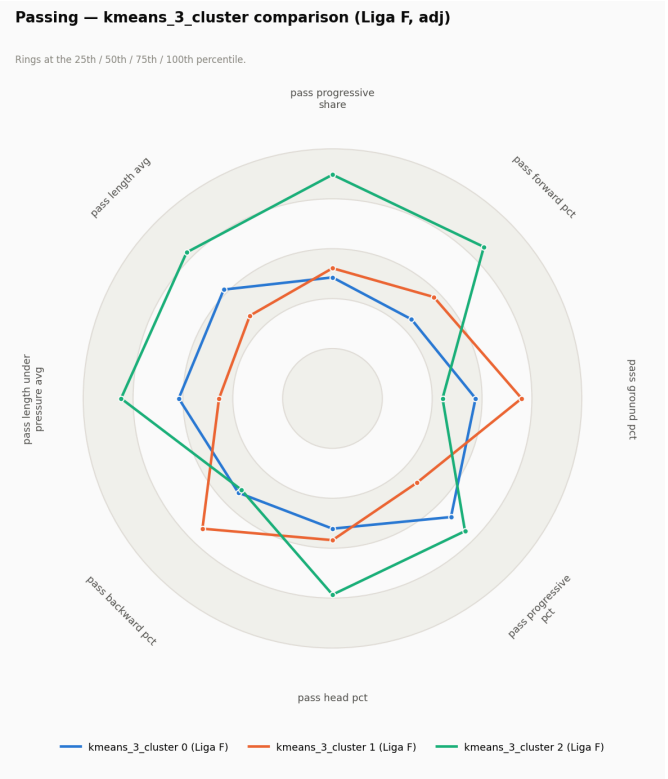


Figure 50: Spain Center Forwards Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt

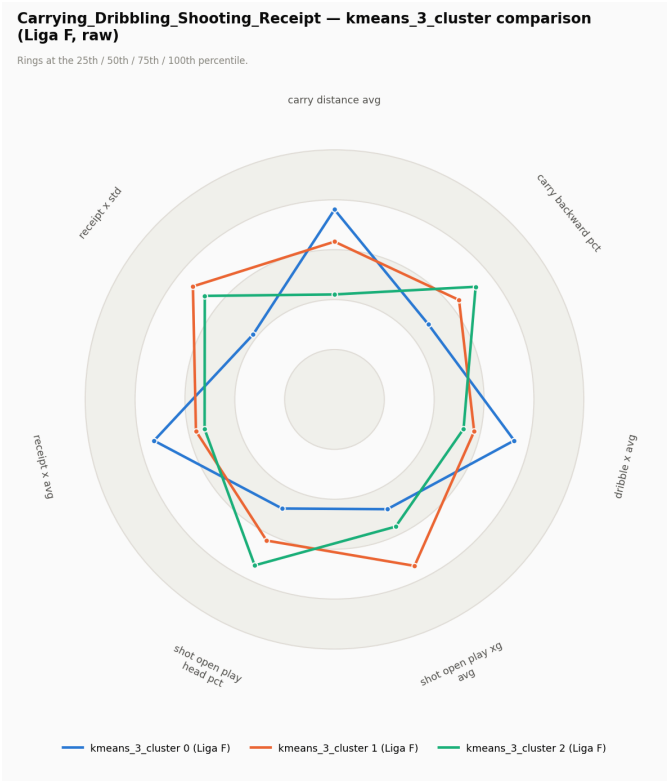


Figure 51: Spain Center Forwards Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

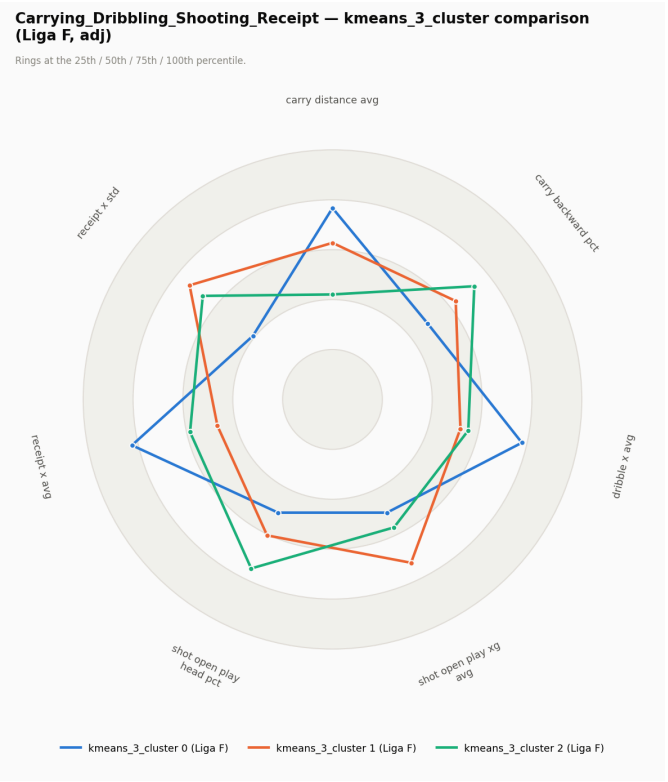


Figure 52: Spain Center Forwards Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

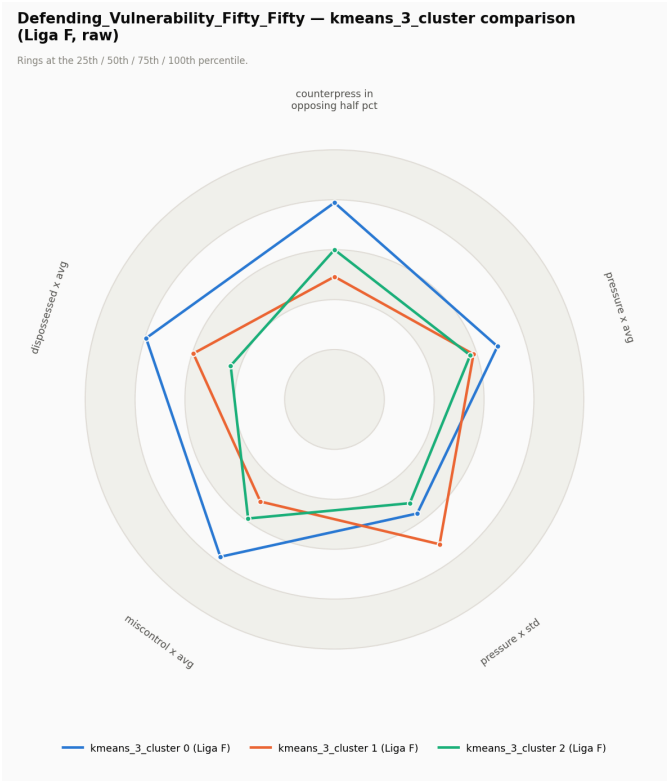


Figure 53: Spain Center Forwards Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

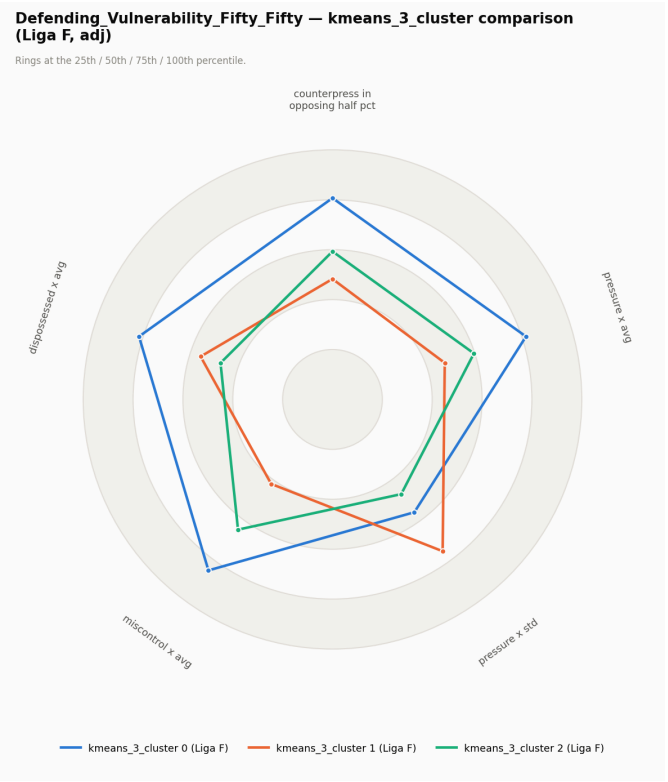


Figure 54: Spain Center Forwards Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Serie A Women

Passing

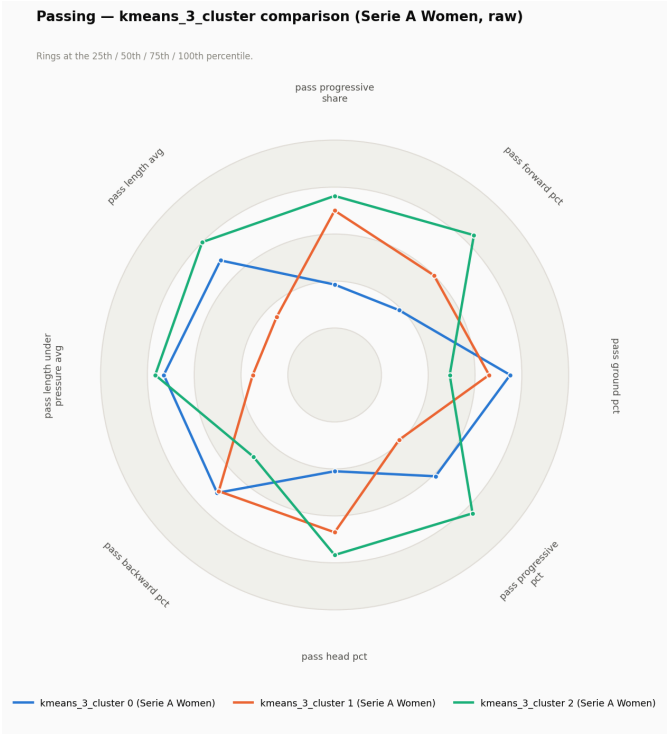


Figure 55: Italy Center Forwards Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

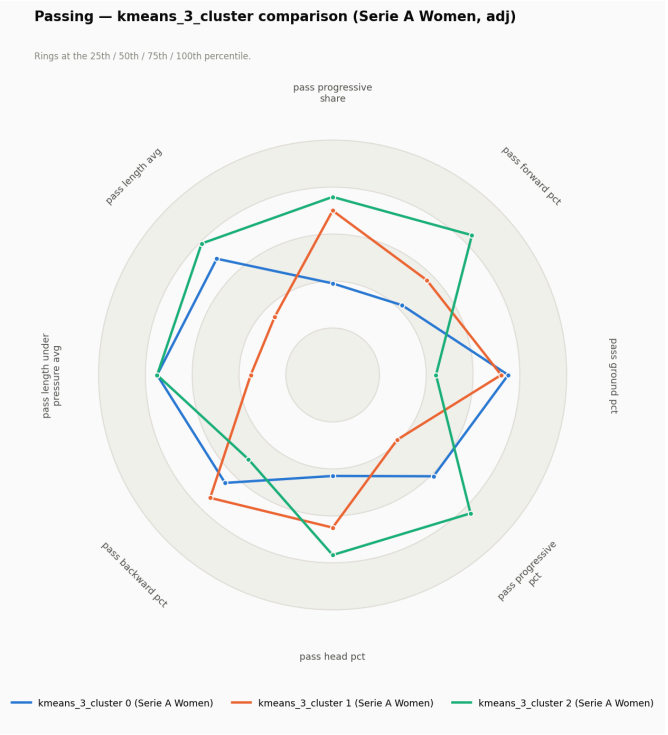


Figure 56: Italy Center Forwards Passing — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt

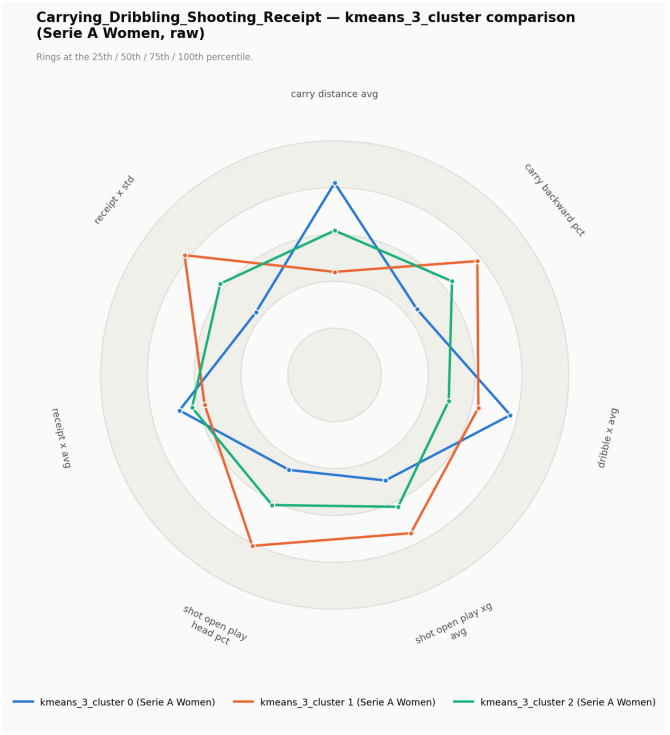


Figure 57: Italy Center Forwards Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

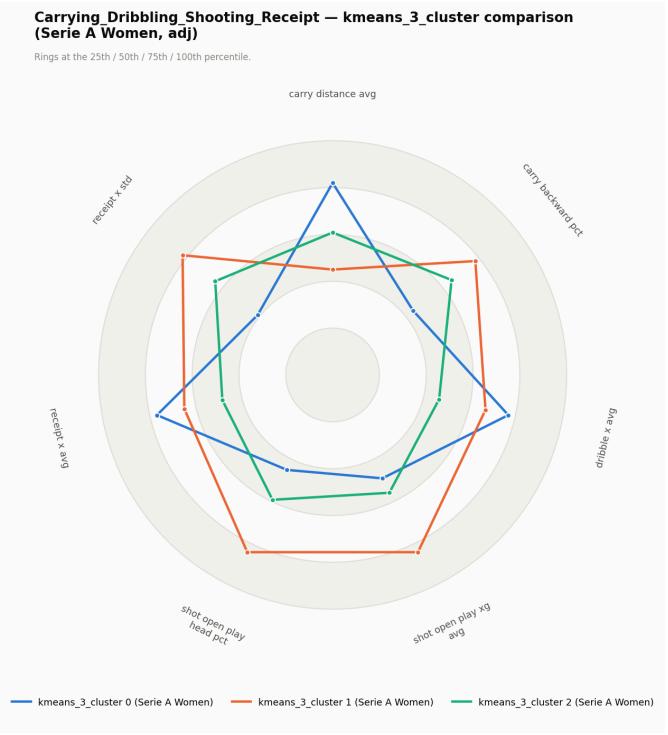


Figure 58: Italy Center Forwards Carrying, Dribbling, Shooting & Receipt — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

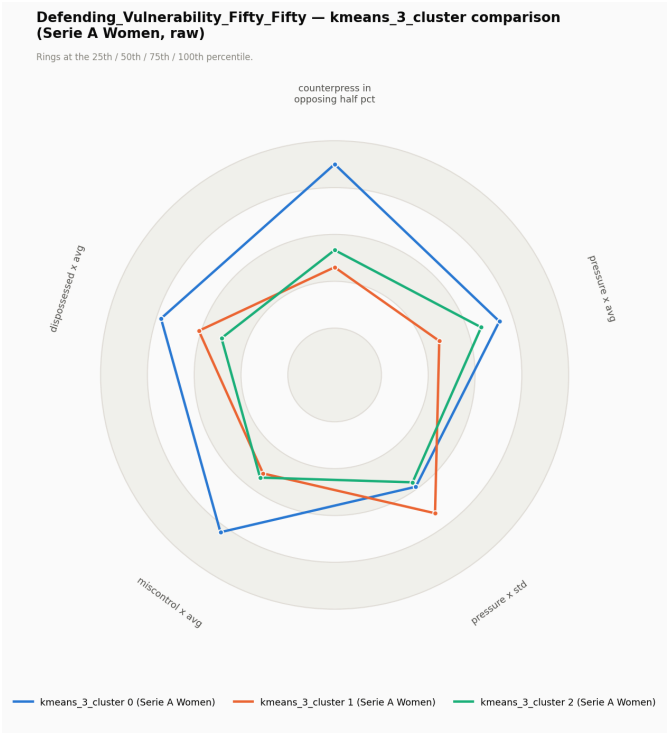


Figure 59: Italy Center Forwards Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

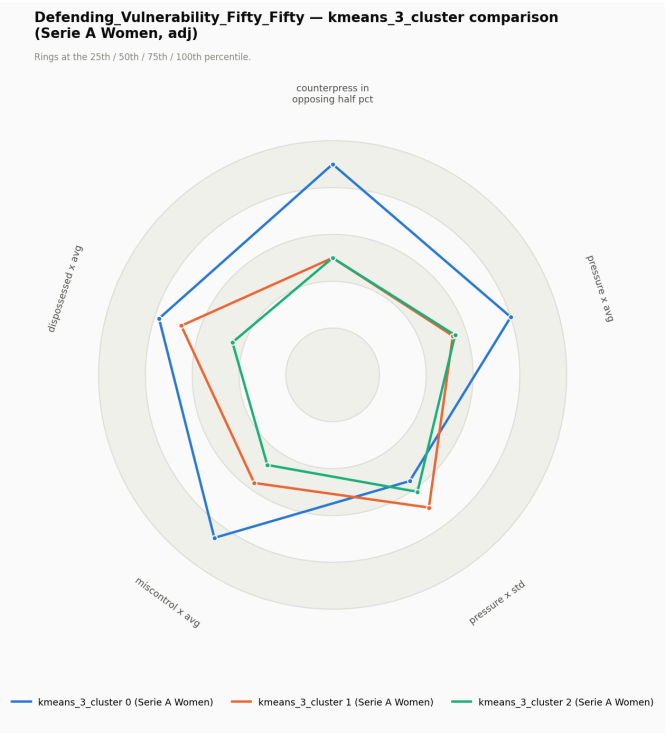


Figure 60: Italy Center Forwards Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters